Graphical Budget Planner 1.9.0

Quick Tutorial

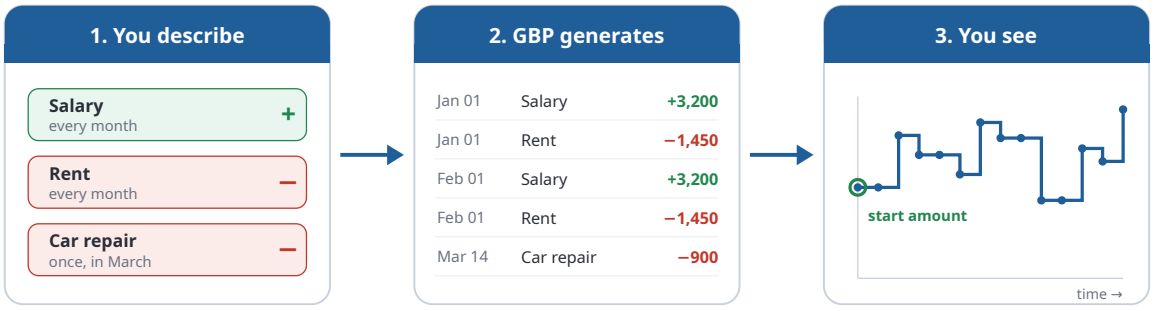
See where your money is heading, in about 15 minutes.

Version : 2026-10-28

This tutorial takes you from an empty window to your first cash balance forecast. Read it in order the first time; afterwards, the last pages work as a reference card.

1 How GBP works

GBP answers one question : **if my incomes and expenses go as planned, how much money will I have on any day in the future ?**



Each income or expense you describe is called a **Cash Stream Definition**, or **CSD**. From the CSDs, GBP computes every future **financial event** (a date and an amount), and adds them up day after day to draw the **Cash Balance curve**.

Good to know

Future only

GBP projects from tomorrow on. It does not record past transactions : it is a planner, not a bookkeeping tool.

One scenario at a time

A **scenario** file holds all your CSDs. Keep as many files as you like ("Today", "If I retire at 60"...), but only one is open at a time.

Start amount

The curve starts from the cash you have **today**, typed at the bottom of the main window. It is **not** saved in the scenario file.

2 Your first scenario in 6 steps

> **Want to look around first ?** **Scenario → Open example** loads a complete sample budget. Nothing you do there can harm your own files.

1 Create the scenario

Scenario → New..., choose the currency, then press **Select**. The currency is permanent : it cannot be changed later.

2 Enter today's cash

Right away, at the bottom of the main window, type the total cash you have today (all accounts together, found by your own means). The curve starts from it. Do this each time you create or open a scenario.

3 Name it

Scenario → Edit... opens the Edit scenario window. Type a **Name** (it is not the file name). Optional : **Annual inflation** and **Duration of calculation** (how many years ahead, 25 by default).

4 Add your incomes and expenses

In the list, first choose **Income** or **Expense**, then press **New Periodic** for anything that repeats, or **New Irregular** for one-off or uneven amounts. Fill in the window that opens and press **Apply**. Repeat for each item.

5 Apply

Back in the Edit scenario window, press **Apply**. The curve in the main window is updated immediately.

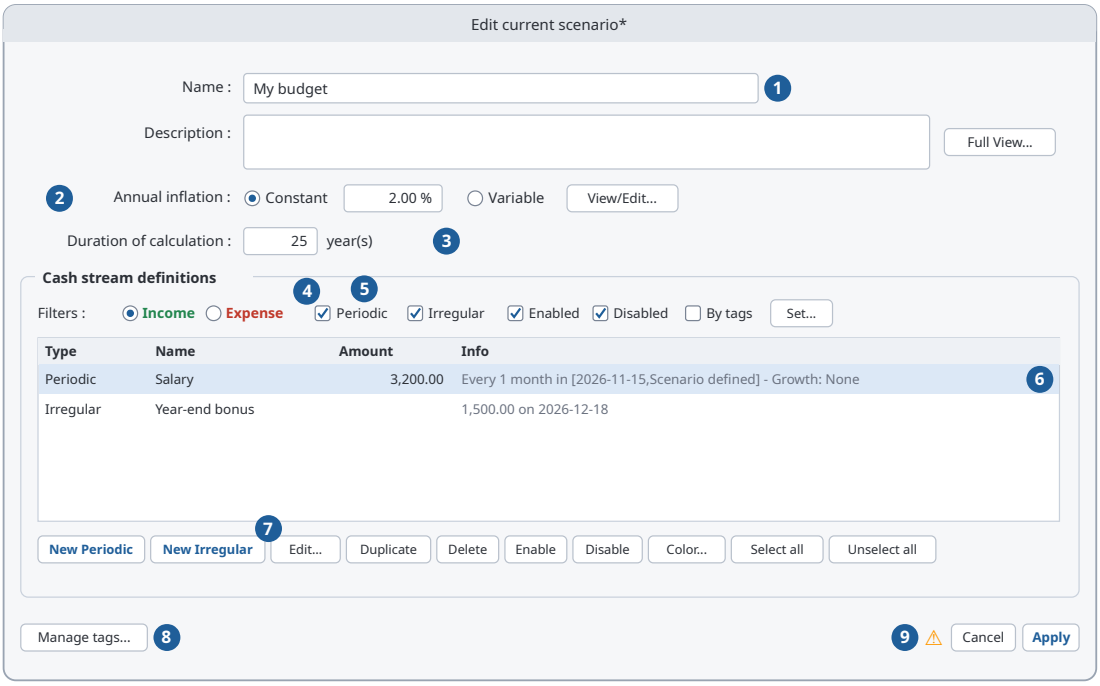
6 Save

Scenario → Save. **Apply** only updates what is in memory : without saving, all changes are lost when you quit GBP.

> **Apply is not Save.** **Apply** shows the result on the curve; only **Scenario → Save** writes it to the file.

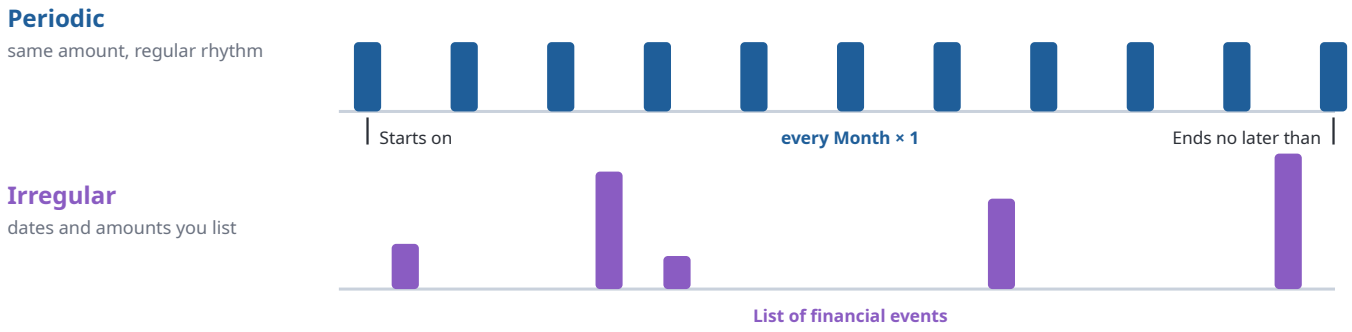
3 The Edit scenario window

Most of the work is done here. Open it with **Scenario → Edit...**.



1	**Name** — The name of the scenario, shown above the curve. It is not the file name.
2	**Annual inflation** — A **Constant** rate, or a **Variable** one, year by year (**View/Edit...**). Each income or expense can then follow it (its **Advanced** tab).
3	**Duration of calculation** — How many years ahead GBP computes the events : 25 by default, from 1 to 100.
4	**Income or Expense** — The list shows either the incomes or the expenses. This choice also sets the type of the next item you create.
5	**Filters** — Show only the periodic or irregular items, the enabled or disabled ones, or those with some tags (**By tags** , **Set...**).
6	**The list** — One line per item. Double-click a line to edit it, or select lines and use the buttons below : **Edit...** , **Duplicate** , **Delete** , **Enable** , **Disable** , **Color...** .
7	**New Periodic, New Irregular** — Create an item of the type chosen in 4. Shortcuts : CTRL+SHIFT+P and CTRL+SHIFT+I.
8	**Manage tags...** — Create tags and link them to items (see the Tags section).
9	**⚠, Cancel and Apply** — The orange ⚠ (and the * in the title) means that some changes are not applied yet. **Apply** sends them to the curve and keeps the window open; **Cancel** forgets them. When there is nothing to apply, only **Close** is shown. **Cancel and Close do not ask : changes that are not applied are lost.**

4 Periodic or irregular ?



Type	Use it for	Examples
Periodic	Amounts that repeat at a regular rhythm	Salary, rent, mortgage, insurance, subscriptions
Irregular	One-time or uneven amounts, on dates you choose	Bonus, gift, car repair, renovation, tax refund

The fields of a periodic item that matter most

Amount	The amount of each occurrence.
Period + Multiplier	The rhythm : Day, Week, Month, End-of-Month or Year, times a multiplier. Month × 3 = every quarter, Week × 2 = every two weeks.
Starts on	The date of the first occurrence.
Ends no later than	By default, the end of the calculation (the scenario's **Duration of calculation**). Choose **Custom** to give an earlier last date.
Advanced tab	Optional growth of the amount : **No growth** , **Follow scenario's inflation** , or your own constant or variable rate.

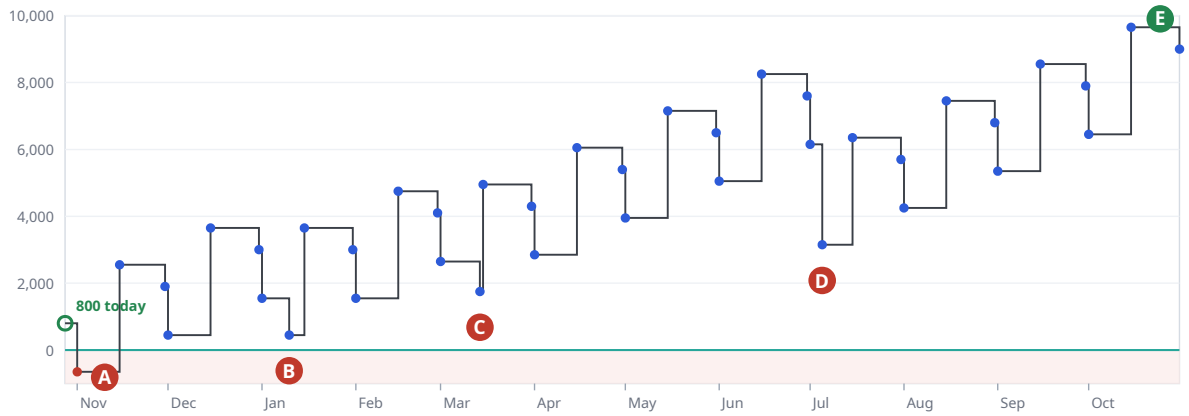
> **Check what you entered :** **View occurrences...** , in the item window, lists every date and amount GBP will generate for that item.

5 A worked example

A small budget, typed as shown on the previous pages. Today is 2026-10-28 and your accounts hold **800** in all : that is the start amount.

Name	Type	Amount	Rhythm	Starts on
Salary	Periodic income	3,200	Month × 1	2026-11-15
Rent	Periodic expense	1,450	Month × 1	2026-11-01
Groceries	Periodic expense	650	End-of-Month × 1	2026-11-30
Car insurance	Periodic expense	1,100	Year × 1	2027-01-10
Car repair	Irregular expense	900	once	2027-03-14
Vacation	Irregular expense	3,000	once	2027-07-05

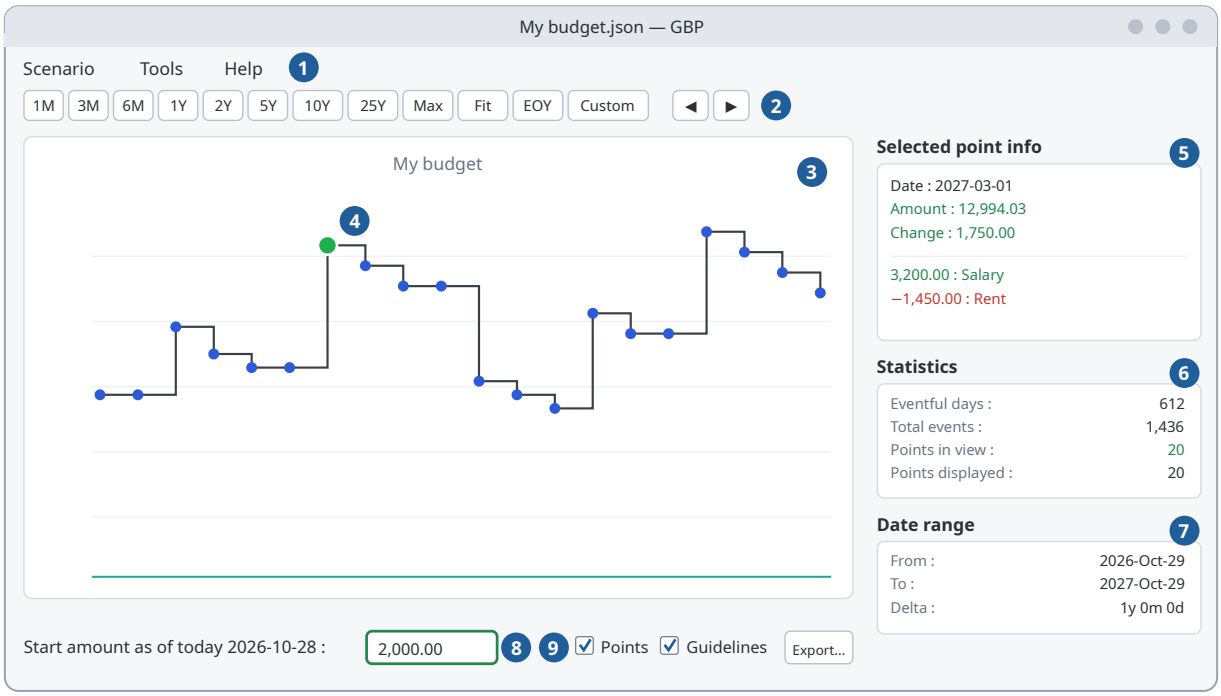
The resulting curve over the next 12 months (**1Y**). Click a point, for example A : **Selected point info** shows its date, balance and events.



What the curve tells you

A	**Nov 1 : −650.** The rent is paid before the first salary : you would be short of 650. Have at least 650 more on Nov 1, or pay the rent later.
B	**Jan 10 : 450.** Rent, then car insurance, before the salary : the lowest point of the year after November, as on Dec 1.
C	**Mar 14 : car repair, −900.** The balance stays positive (1,750).
D	**Jul 5 : vacation, −3,000.** Affordable : 3,150 are left.
E	**Oct 31, 2027 : 9,000.** Every month adds 1,100 (3,200 − 1,450 − 650).

6 The main window at a glance



1	**Menus** — **Scenario** for files and editing, **Tools** for Analysis and Options, **Help** for this tutorial and the User Manual.
2	**Time range buttons** — Show the next 1 month … 25 years. **Max** : the whole calculation. **Fit** : the date range of all events. **EOY** : until the end of this year. **Custom** : dates you choose. ◄ ► : move one window left or right.
3	**The Cash Balance curve** — Each point is the balance at the end of a day with at least one event. The flat line is zero : below it, you are short of cash.
4	**Click a point** — It is highlighted and becomes the selected point.
5	**Selected point info** — Date, balance, change for that day, and the list of all the events of that day.
6	**Statistics** — **Eventful days** : how many days have at least one event. **Total events** : how many events in total. **Points in view** : points in the visible part of the chart, in green when they are shown, in red when there are too many to show them (zoom in; the limit is set in Options). **Points displayed** : how many are actually shown.
7	**Date range** — First (**From**) and last (**To**) day in view, and the span between them (**Delta** , in years, months and days).
8	**Start amount** — Your cash as of today. Change it at any time : the curve moves up or down.
9	**Display options** — **Points** shows or hides the dots (an ⓘ appears next to it when there are too many to show), **Guidelines** the grid. **Export...** saves all the curve's points to a CSV file.

7 Moving around the curve

Do this	To
Mouse wheel	Zoom in or out, around the mouse pointer
SHIFT + mouse wheel	Zoom on time only (horizontal)
CTRL + mouse wheel	Zoom on amounts only (vertical)
Left-click and drag	Move the curve in any direction
Click a point	See the details and the events of that day
◀ or ▶	Jump one full window back or forward in time
A time range button	Reset the view (1M ... 25Y, Max, Fit, EOY, Custom)

> **Lost in the chart ?** Press **Fit** to see everything again.

8 Tags

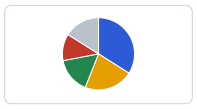
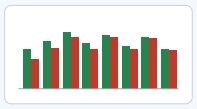
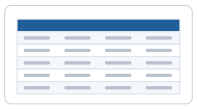
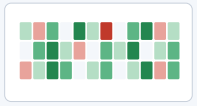
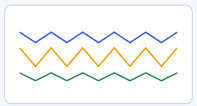
Tags are labels you put on CSDs ("Housing", "Car", "Leisure"...) to group them. A CSD can have several tags.

1. In the Edit scenario window, press **Manage tags...** .
2. Create your tags and choose the CSDs linked to each one. You can also link tags from an item window, in **Linked tags** .
3. Use them to filter the list (**By tags**) and in the **Tags** tab of the Analysis.

9 Analysis

Tools → Analysis... turns the financial events of a period into charts and tables, to understand where the money comes from and where it goes.

1	Open **Tools → Analysis...** (a scenario must be loaded).
2	Choose the period with **From** and **To** (by default : tomorrow to 5 years later), then press **Apply dates**. Every tab uses this period : change it to compare, for example, this year with your first year of retirement.
3	Pick a tab. **Export chart...** saves the chart as a PNG image, **Export legend...** saves the table or legend as a CSV file. The **Help** tab describes every tab.

Tab	What you see	Try this
 **Relative weight**	A pie chart of the incomes (or expenses) that weigh the most over the period. The smaller ones are grouped in one "Others" slice.	Choose **Income** or **Expenses**. Set **No of most significant items**. Click a slice or a legend line to see its **Rank**, **Percentage** and **Amount**.
 **Period - chart**	Bars of income and expenses, one per month or per year.	**Monthly** or **Annual**. **Duration** : how many bars at a time, ◀ ▶ to move. Show **Income**, **Expenses**, both, or **Deltas** (income minus expenses).
 **Period - list**	The same figures as a table : income, expenses and delta, their growth from one period to the next, and the cash balance.	**Monthly** or **Annual**. **Export legend...** saves the table for a spreadsheet.
 **Period - heatmap**	One colored cell per month (a year × month grid) or per year : the stronger the color, the bigger the amount. Good and bad periods stand out at a glance.	**Incomes**, **Expenses** or **Delta** (surpluses in the Max color, shortfalls in the Min color). **Exclude current month** hides an incomplete month. **Cell size**.
 **Tags**	For the tags you choose : total amount, weight (%) and number of events. Select a tag to see which CSDs make it up (table and pie chart).	**Income** or **Expenses**, then **Select tags...**.
 **Compare CSD**	The financial events of up to 10 CSDs on one chart, one color each, with the total of each over the period.	Check the CSDs in the list. Click a point to see its date and amount. **Fit** rescales the chart.

10 Common questions

? I changed something, but the curve did not move.
Press **Apply**. An orange ⚠ next to the buttons (and a * in the window title) means that some changes are not applied yet.

? My start amount went back to 0.
That is normal : it is not saved, and goes back to 0 each time a scenario is created or opened. Type today's cash again.

? The dots of the curve disappeared.
There are too many points in view to show them : an ⓘ appears next to **Points**. Zoom in, or raise **Max number of points shown** in **Tools → Options...**.

? An income or expense is missing from the curve.
It may be disabled (check the **Enabled** and **Disabled** filters of the Edit scenario window), or start after the end of the calculation. **View occurrences...**, in its window, lists the dates it generates.

? The curve stops too early.
Raise **Duration of calculation** in the Edit scenario window (25 years by default, up to 100). Press **Max** to see the whole calculation.

? Can I change the currency ?
No : it is chosen once, when the scenario is created. **Scenario → Properties...** shows it.

11 Good habits

- ✓ Save after each work session : **Scenario → Save**.
- ✓ Update the start amount each time you open the scenario, using your accounts.
- ✓ Keep one scenario per "what if" : copy it with **Scenario → Save as...** and change only what differs.
- ✓ Disable a CSD (instead of deleting it) to see the curve without it.
- ✓ Not sure what a field does ? Hover over it : most fields have a tooltip.

> **To learn more** — The **User Manual** (**Help → User manual**) explains every window and every option in detail.